

FESTE

Master Malvolio?

MALVOLIO

Ay, good fool.

FESTE

Alas, sir, how fell you besides your five wits?

MALVOLIO

Fool, there was never a man so notoriously abused: I am as well in my wits, fool, as thou art.

FESTE

But as well? then you are mad indeed, if you be no better in your wits than a fool.

MALVOLIO

They have here propertyed me; keep me in darkness, send ministers to me, asses, and do all they can to face me out of my wits.

FESTE

Advise you what you say; the minister is here.

(In the voice of Sir Topas.)

Malvolio, Malvolio, thy wits the heavens restore! endeavour thyself to sleep, and leave thy vain babble.

MALVOLIO

Sir Topas!

FESTE

(as Sir Topas)

Maintain no words with him, good fellow.

(as himself)

Who, I, sir? not I, sir. God be wi' you, good Sir Topas.

(as Sir Topas)

Marry, amen.

(as himself)

I will, sir, I will.

MALVOLIO

Fool, fool, fool, I say!

FESTE

Alas, sir, be patient. What say you sir? I am shent for speaking to you.

MALVOLIO

Good fool, help me to some light and some paper: I tell thee, I am as well in my wits as any man in Illyria.

FESTE

Well-a-day that you were, sir

MALVOLIO

By this hand, I am. Good fool, some ink, paper and light; and convey what I will set down to my lady: it shall advantage thee more than ever the bearing of letter did.

FESTE

I will help you to't. But tell me true, are you not mad indeed? or do you but counterfeit?

MALVOLIO

Believe me, I am not; I tell thee true.

FESTE

Nay, I'll ne'er believe a madman till I see his brains. I will fetch you light and paper and ink.

MALVOLIO

Fool, I'll requite it in the highest degree: I prithee, be gone.

FESTE

(Singing)

*I am gone, sir, and anon, sir,
I'll be with you again,
In a trice, like to the old Vice,
Your need to sustain;*

Who, with dagger of lath, in his rage and his wrath,

Cries, 'ah, ha!' to the devil:

Like a mad lad, 'Pare thy nails, dad!

Aldieu, goodman devil.'

(Exeunt omnes.)

TOBY

To him in thine own voice, and bring me word how thou findest him: I would we were well rid of this knavery. If he may be conveniently delivered, I would he were, for I am now so far in offence with my niece that I cannot pursue with any safety this sport to the upshot. Come by and by to my chamber.

(Exeunt SIR TOBY BELCH and MARIA.)

FESTE

(Singing, in his own voice)

'Hey, Robin, jolly Robin,

Tell me how thy lady does.'

MALVOLIO

Fool!

FESTE

'My lady is unkind, perdy.'

MALVOLIO

Fool!

FESTE

'Alas, why is she so?'

MALVOLIO

Fool, I say!

FESTE

'She loves another'—

Who calls, ha?

MALVOLIO

Good fool, as ever thou wilt deserve well at my hand, help me to a candle, and pen, ink and paper: as I am a gentleman, I will live to be thankful to thee for't.

FESTE

Madman, thou errest: I say, there is no darkness but ignorance; in which thou art more puzzled than the Egyptians in their fog.

MALVOLIO

I say, this house is as dark as ignorance, though ignorance were as dark as hell; and I say, there was never man thus abused. I am no more mad than you are: make the trial of it in any constant question.

FESTE

What is the opinion of Pythagoras concerning wild fowl?

MALVOLIO

That the soul of our grandam might haply inhabit a bird.

FESTE

What thinkest thou of his opinion?

MALVOLIO

I think nobly of the soul, and no way approve his opinion.

FESTE

Fare thee well. Remain thou still in darkness: thou shalt hold the opinion of Pythagoras ere I will allow of thy wits, and fear to kill a woodcock, lest thou dispossess the soul of thy grandam. Fare thee well.

MALVOLIO

Sir Topas, Sir Topas!

TOBY

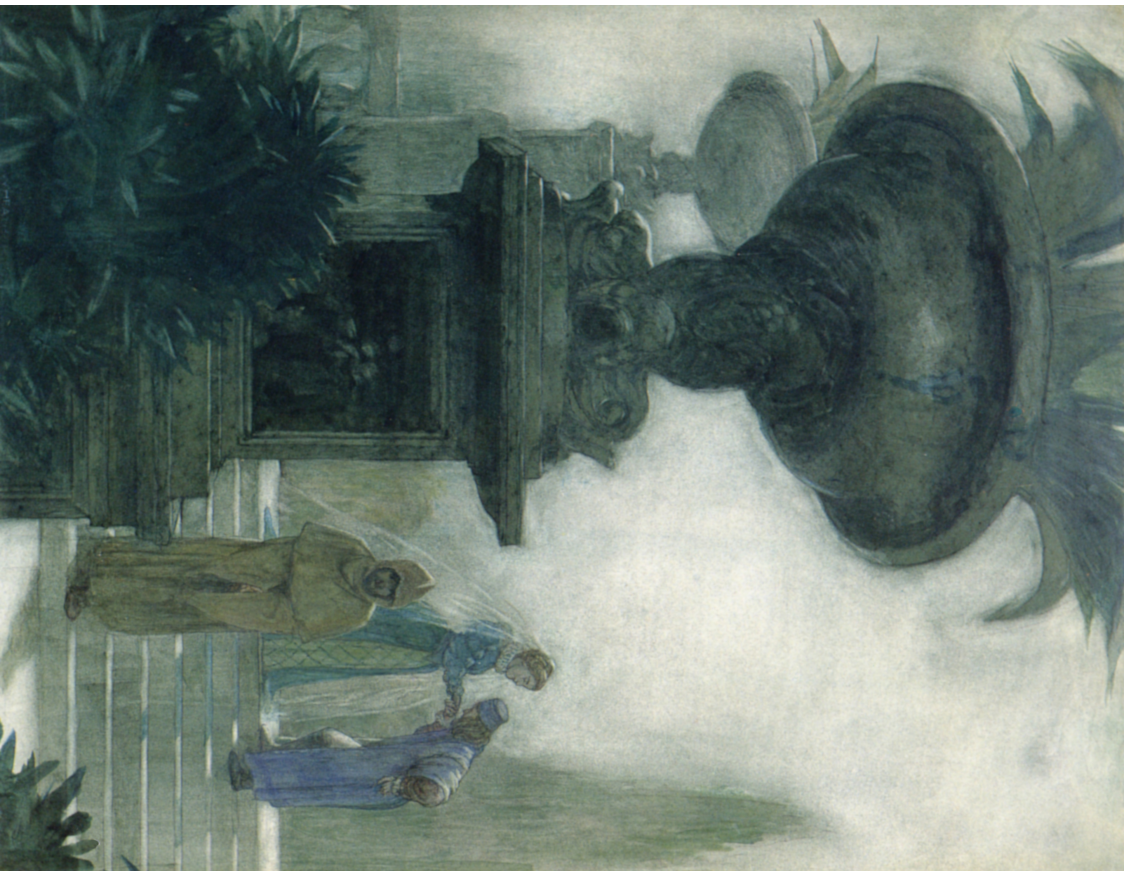
My most exquisite Sir Topas!

FESTE

Nay, I am for all waters.

MARIA

Thou mightst have done this without thy beard and gown: he sees thee not.



'BLAME NOT THIS HASTE OF MINE'



'THEY HAVE LAID ME HERE IN HIDEOUS DARKNESS'

TOBY

The knave counterfeit's well; a good knave.

MALVOLIO

(*Within*)

Who calls there?

FESTE

Sir Topas the curate, who comes to visit Malvolio the lunatic.

MALVOLIO

Sir Topas, Sir Topas, good Sir Topas, go to my lady.

FESTE

Out, hyperbolical fiend! how vexest thou this man! talkest thou nothing but of ladies?

TOBY

[*Aside*] *Well said, Master Parson.*

MALVOLIO

Sir Topas, never was man thus wronged: good Sir Topas, do not think I am mad: they have laid me here in hideous darkness.

FESTE

Fie, thou dishonest Satan! I call thee by the most modest terms; for I am one of those gentle ones that will use the devil himself with courtesy: sayest thou that house is dark?

MALVOLIO

As hell, Sir Topas.

FESTE

Why it hath bay windows transparent as barricadoes, and the clerestories toward the south-north are as lustrous as ebony; and yet complainest thou of obstruction?

MALVOLIO

I am not mad, Sir Topas: I say to you, this house is dark.

Scene 3

OLIVIA's garden.

(*Enter SEBASTIAN.*)

SEBASTIAN

This is the air; that is the glorious sun;
This pearl she gave me, I do feel't and see't;
And though 'tis wonder that enwraps me thus,
Yet 'tis not madness. Where's Antonio, then?
I could not find him at the Elephant:
Yet there he was; and there I found this credit,
That he did range the town to seek me out.
His counsel now might do me golden service;
For though my soul disputes well with my sense,
That this may be some error, but no madness,
Yet doth this accident and flood of fortune
So far exceed all instance, all discourse,
That I am ready to distrust mine eyes
And wrangle with my reason that persuades me
To any other trust but that I am mad
Or else the lady's mad; yet, if 'twere so,
She could not sway her house, command her followers,
Take and give back affairs and their dispatch
With such a smooth, discreet and stable bearing
As I perceive she does: there's something in't
That is deceivable. But here the lady comes.
(*Enter OLIVIA and PRIEST.*)

OLIVIA

Blame not this haste of mine. If you mean well,
Now go with me and with this holy man
Into the chantry by: there, before him,
And underneath that consecrated roof,

Plight me the full assurance of your faith;
That my most jealous and too doubtful soul
May live at peace. He shall conceal it
Whiles you are willing it shall come to note,
What time we will our celebration keep
According to my birth. What do you say?

SEBASTIAN

I'll follow this good man, and go with you;
And, having sworn truth, ever will be true.

OLIVIA

Then lead the way, good father; and heavens so shine,
That they may fairly note this act of mine!

(Exeunt omnes.)

Scene 2

OLIVIA'S house.

(Enter MARIA and FESTE.)

MARIA

Nay, I prithee, put on this gown and this beard; make him believe
thou art Sir Topas the curate: do it quickly; I'll call Sir Toby the
whilst.

(Exit MARIA.)

FESTE

Well, I'll put it on, and I will dissemble myself in't; and I would I
were the first that ever dissembled in such a gown.

(He puts on gown and beard.)

I am not tall enough to become the function well, nor lean enough
to be thought a good student; but to be said an honest man and a
good housekeeper goes as fairly as to say a careful man and a great
scholar. The competitors enter.

(Enter Sir TOBY BELCH and MARIA.)

TOBY

Jove bless thee, master Parson.

FESTE

Bonas dies, Sir Toby: for, as the old hermit of Prague, that never saw
pen and ink, very wittily said to a niece of King Gorboduc, 'That
that is is,' so I, being Master Parson, am Master Parson; for, what is
'that' but 'that,' and 'is' but 'is'?

TOBY

To him, Sir Topas.

FESTE

(Disguising his voice)
What, ho, I say! peace in this prison!